database will state that the Twitter status update was posted, but in reality, it wasn't. You need to make a choice: tolerate a missing status update, or tolerate multiple status updates. Hint: it's a business decision. Figure 16.6 shows the flow of both solutions.

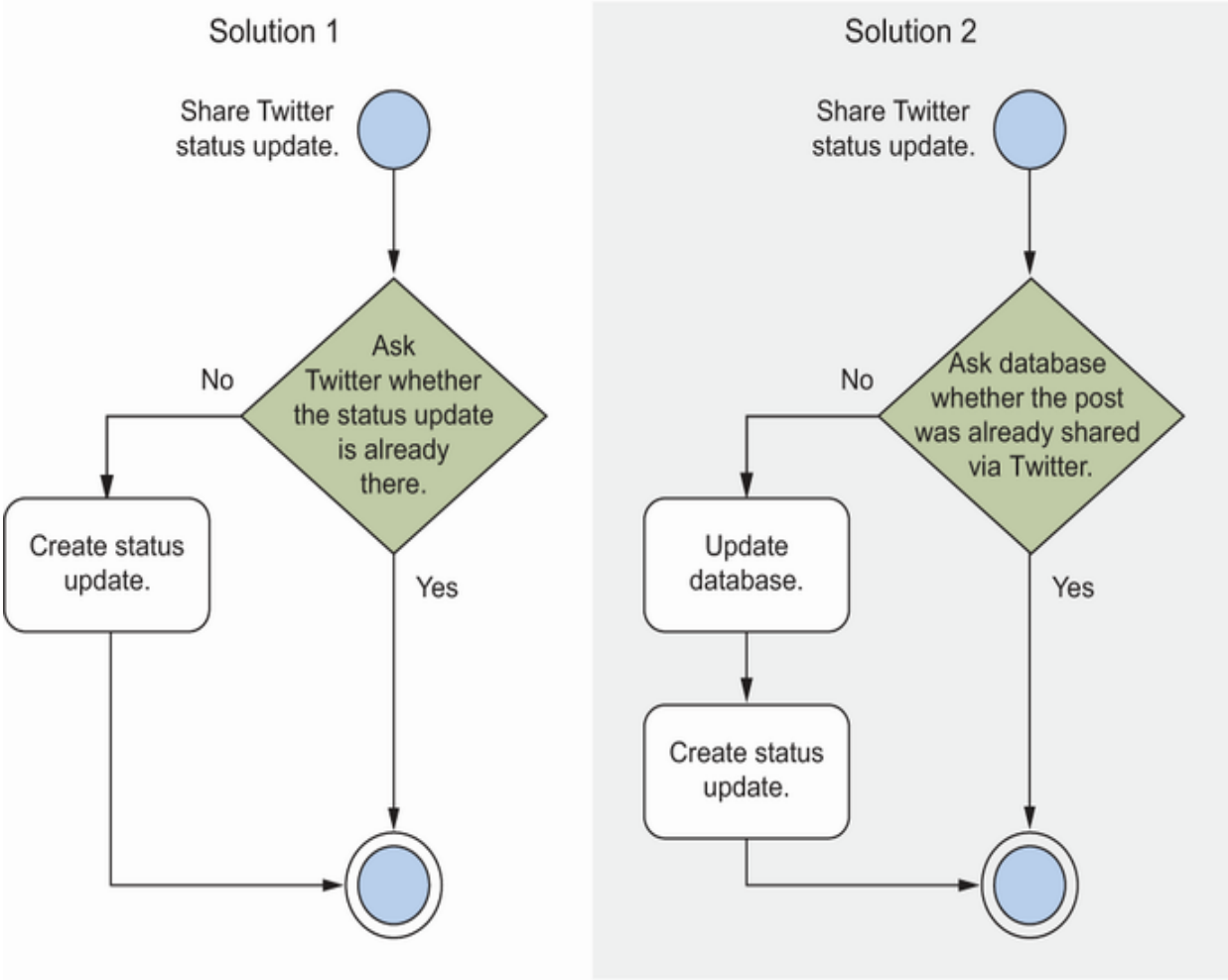


Figure 16.6 Idempotent Twitter status update: Share a status update only if it hasn't already been done.

Now it's time for a practical example! You'll design, implement, and deploy a distributed, fault-tolerant web application on AWS. This example will demonstrate how distributed systems work and will combine most of the knowledge in this book.